



server solution stack package developed by Apache Friends, consisting mainly of the Apache HTTP Server, MariaDB database, and interpreters for scripts written in the PHP and Perl programming languages.

2. Download XAMPP:

- Go to the XAMPP website.
- Download the XAMPP installer for your operating system.

3. Install XAMPP:

- Run the downloaded installer and follow the instructions.
- During installation, select components such as Apache and PHP. MariaDB is selected by default, which is necessary for database integration.

4. Start Apache Server:

- Open the XAMPP Control Panel.
- Start the Apache module by clicking the “Start” button next to it.

Setting Up a Development Environment:

1. Text Editor/IDE:

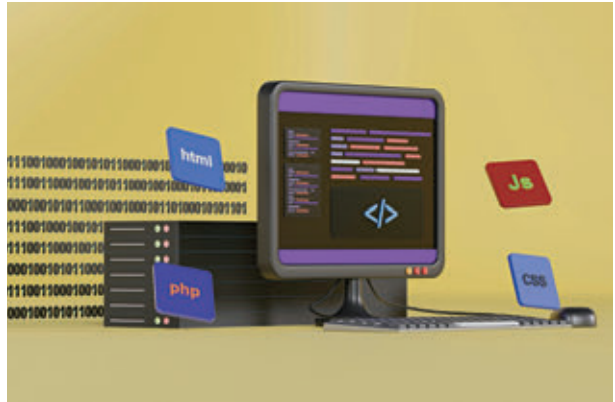
- Use a text editor or IDE for writing PHP code. Some popular choices include:
 - **VS Code:** Download from Visual Studio Code (<https://code.visualstudio.com/>).
 - **Sublime Text:** Download from Sublime Text (<https://www.sublimetext.com/>).
 - **PhpStorm:** A commercial IDE from JetBrains, specifically designed for PHP development.

2. Configuring Your IDE:

- Install PHP extensions or plugins in your chosen text editor or IDE to enhance PHP development.

Basic PHP Syntax

Understanding the basic syntax of PHP is essential for writing



your first program. Here are some fundamental concepts and constructs:

Variables and Data Types:

PHP supports various data types, including integers, floats, strings, arrays, and objects. Variables in PHP are declared using the \$ symbol.

```
<?php
// Integer
$age = 25;

// Float
$height = 5.9;

// String
$name = "Alice";

// Boolean
$is_student = true;
?>
```

Comments:

Comments in PHP can be single-line, starting with // or #, or multi-line, enclosed in /* */.

```
<?php
// This is a single-line comment

# This is also a single-line comment

/*
This is a
multi-line comment
*/
?>
```

Control Structures:

PHP supports control structures like conditionals and loops.

```
<?php
```